

UBER 'FLOATS' A NEW SERVICE IN SRINAGAR

Bringing a modern twist to a traditional treasure of Kashmir, Uber has just launched Uber Shikara. Via the ride-sharing app, you can now book a boat ride of up to one hour for 1-4 passengers between the different ghats on the Dal Lake. The service is offered between 10 am and 5 pm and bookings can be made 12 hours to 15 days in advance. The best part? Uber won't be charging the shikara 'drivers' a booking fee; they will get 100 per cent of the ride price, thus supporting local tourism.

VANDE BHARAT SLEEPER TRAIN READY TO TAKE BERTH

The Indian Railways is launching the Vande Bharat long-distance sleeper trains, the first of which will soon undergo field trials. While the routes haven't been disclosed for the feature-rich superfast trains, the pricing will reportedly be at par with the Rajdhani. The Vande Bharat sleeper trains will adhere to high standards. Think EN-45545 HL3 compliant fire safety, CCTV monitoring, emergency talk-back unit and a crash-safe design. They promise jerk-free, semi-permanent couplers and anti-climbers, a regenerative braking system for energy efficiency, and higher average speed with quick deceleration and acceleration. For comfort, they offer ergonomically designed ladders for ease of climbing on to upper berths, centrally controlled automatic plug doors, wider gangways, accommodation and accessible toilets for passengers with restricted mobility. There's also a centralised coach monitoring system for air-conditioning, saloon lighting and such.



A RIVER RUNS THROUGH IT

All roads lead to the mighty Brahmaputra this winter. Lachit Ghat in Assam is the breathtakingly beautiful venue for the three month-long Brahmaputra Carnival that goes on till March 15, 2025. Adventure junkies can enjoy exciting activities such as glamping, watersports, live concerts, ATV rides, speedboat rides, river rafting, kayaking, water rolling, archery, bungee jumping, and jet skiing. It will also be a showcase of the region's culture and culinary heritage, handicrafts by local artisans, and the talent of traditional musicians and performers. The carnival site is just 2.4 km from the Guwahati Railway Station and 22.5 km from the Guwahati airport. The immersive experience can be extended with tours to the Kamakhya or Umananda temples and the Pobitora Wildlife Sanctuary. This grand celebration is a chance to get a taste of Assam's vibrant culture.

Compiled by Priya Pathiyan